Module 3: Problem Discovery and Market Research

Detailed supplement: market research and user research from the Week 3 deck, with a worked discovery case study



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MODULE 3 · HOW TO USE THIS SUPPLEMENT

Coverage map: what is new and what is already in the module

Read this supplement next to the main Module 3 handbook. **Extended** means the handbook has the topic and this PDF adds the deck's example. **New** means the handbook did not have it. The Uber case follows the same method as an end-to-end example.

Topic (Week 3 deck)	Handbook section	Status here
What problem discovery is and why it matters	3.1	Extended: four reasons from the deck
Primary and secondary research, combined	3.2	New: definitions and a worked combination
Market sizing: TAM, SAM and SOM	3.9 (partial)	New: TAM is missing from the handbook
Porter's Five Forces	—	New: five forces and their questions
Competitive analysis	3.9	New: scored comparison and the trade-off lesson
Surveys and their limits	3.4	Extended: fill rate falls after about five questions
Passive and active observation	—	New: how to run each
One-to-many and in-depth interviews	3.3	Extended: format and length
Personas: what they are and are not	3.5	Extended: the test for a useful persona
Worked discovery case: Uber pickup	3.7, 3.8	New: the full method, step by step

NOTE ON THE SOURCE

Some slides in the Week 3 deck are pictures with no readable text. Only the text labels are used here, and no figures are added beyond the source.

WEEK 3 · SECTION 3.1

What problem discovery is, and why it matters

Problem discovery is the process of identifying, understanding and validating the real problems your users face, before you build anything. The deck's point: value is in what gets used, not in what gets built.

Reason	Why it matters
Solve the right problem	Stops effort going to a feature nobody needs
Prevent product failure	Catches the wrong problem before the build
Align with real user need	Gives the team one shared picture of the user
Build user empathy	Makes the PM notice pain that data alone misses

After discovering problems, the next step is to understand the market: is the problem big enough to be worth solving at scale?

Primary and secondary research

Market research tells you whether a problem is worth solving at scale. It gives a strategic view of the opportunity and its competitors.

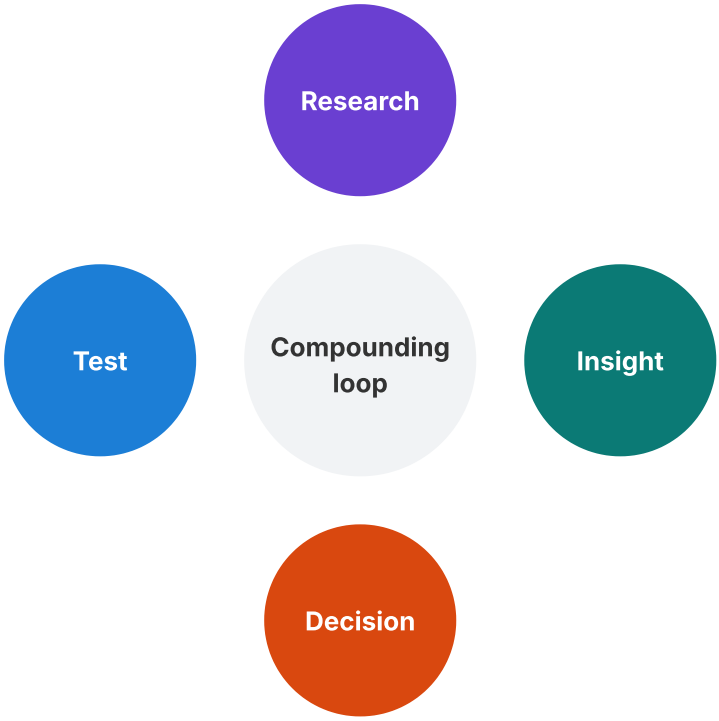
Type	What it is	Why PMs use it
Primary	New data you collect yourself, from users directly	Understand real pain; validate needs
Secondary	Existing data collected by someone else	Benchmark; understand the landscape

Combine both. Example for a fintech app for college students: primary research means interviewing ten students about their money habits; secondary research means reading public trends on digital payments among young adults.

WEEK 3 · DIAGRAM

The discovery loop

Discovery is a loop: each test feeds the next research question. Use the loop to decide what to learn next, not only what to build.



Discovery loop: research, insight, decision, test

NEW · MARKET SIZING

TAM, SAM and SOM

Market sizing estimates the potential of a market in three nested layers. The deck uses a pizza restaurant as the example.



Size the outer ring first.
Then cut to people you
can reach with your model.
Last, the share you can win.

TAM, SAM and SOM as nested circles

Term	Stands for	What it means	Example from the deck
TAM	Total addressable market	Total demand if everyone used the product	All possible customers who could buy pizza in the country
SAM	Serviceable available market	The part you can reach with your model	Customers in your city who would order from you
SOM	Serviceable obtainable market	The share you can realistically win in a few years	The customers one restaurant can serve

WATCH OUT

A big TAM does not prove that your problem is big. Size the people who have the problem, not only the market. Label every assumption and its source.

NEW · MARKET FORCES

Porter's Five Forces

Porter's Five Forces asks how attractive a market is. Each force gives one question to answer.

Force	Question to ask
Threat of new entrants	How easy is it for a new player to enter?
Threat of substitutes	What else can the customer use instead?
Bargaining power of buyers	How much can customers push on price or terms?
Bargaining power of suppliers	How much can suppliers push on cost or terms?
Rivalry among existing competitors	How hard do current players fight for the same customers?

EXTENDED · COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

Compare competitors on what matters

Competitive analysis means identifying, evaluating and benchmarking competitors: their strengths, weaknesses, positioning and threats. Use it to find a market gap and to prepare your positioning.

The deck's case is an AI transcription startup. Each competitor is scored from 1 (weak) to 4 (strong) on speed, price and error rate, so the trade-offs are explicit. The scores below are illustrative.

Competitor	Speed	Price	Error
Competitor A	1	1	4
Competitor B	4	3	2
Competitor C	3	2	3
Competitor D	2	4	1

The lesson: the table makes your trade-offs visible and shows where the gap is. Pick the dimension where you can be clearly best, then check that the market cares about it.

NEW · RESEARCH METHODS

Passive and active observation

Observation shows how people actually use a product, not how they say they use it.

Method	How to run it	Watch for
Passive observation	Study a user flow chart, pick the flow most users repeat, then watch screen recordings or analytics for the steps where people stop.	Where people hesitate, repeat or give up
Active observation	Ask a user to complete tasks on your product, a competitor's, or a prototype, while you watch and talk with them.	Whether people understand the screen, and can use it alone

- Give goals, not steps: 'how would you book a seat?', not 'click this button'.
- Prepare two or three tasks.
- Tell users it is a prototype if it looks finished, so they do not feel judged.

EXTENDED · SURVEYS

Surveys give a pulse, not a decision

A survey gives a general pulse from users. It helps you decide which direction to explore further, or to drop it. It needs enough responses to show reliable patterns.

- Fill rate falls sharply after about five questions. Keep it short.
- Do not make strategic decisions from survey results alone. Always augment them with a deeper method.

EXTENDED · RESEARCH METHODS

One-to-many and in-depth interviews

Method	Format	Use it to
One-to-many conversation	A moderated group discussion about perceptions and beliefs, across segments; participants talk freely	Hear several views at once and spot shared themes
In-depth interview	One-on-one, 30 to 60 minutes, with a guide you can depart from to follow up	Understand one person's reasons in depth

EXTENDED · PERSONAS

What a persona is, and what it is not

A persona is a model of a user group built from research, not from assumption. The deck's test: a persona that lists only a name, gender, birth year, city and marital status is not useful. A useful persona shows the goal, the context, the pain, and the moment the user decides.

EXAMPLE (FROM THE DECK)

A persona for paying by UPI at fuel stations: who pays, why they pay at a pump, what goes wrong, and what they need to finish quickly.

CASE STUDY · STEP 1

Who we design for

Start by naming the people, not the product. The case splits riders into four groups, each with a different pain:

Segment	Who	Pain	What they need
Tech-park commuters	Daily riders aged 24 to 34 on IT corridors	Many gates; the pin goes to the main entrance; repeated calls when a driver cannot find them	Exit-specific pickup guidance
Mall visitors	Shoppers and diners aged 18 to 35	Many entries and parking zones; crowds at weekends	One easy-to-find spot, shared with the driver
Airport travellers	Frequent flyers aged 22 to 45, time-sensitive	Large, multi-level terminals; zones exist but are not obvious	Clear terminal and gate guidance with little delay
First-time riders	New to ride-hailing or to the city, aged 18 to 30	Unsure of pickup norms; anxious about missing the ride	A guided flow that builds confidence

The shared pattern: an unclear pickup point leads to manual calls or texts, wasted time, and more cancellations. The one core need is a guided, reliable and easy pickup.

CASE STUDY · STEP 2

Sizing the opportunity, with its assumptions

The case uses a top-down size: total market, then the part that is app-based, then the part the team could reach. Every step is written as an assumption you can challenge. The case's headline figure for the wider market is shown in the source; check current industry sources before you quote any market number.

- Write the market in three nested layers: total, app-based, and reachable.
- Label each layer's source and its date.
- Keep one sentence for what would make the number wrong.

WATCH OUT

A large market size does not prove that your specific problem is big. Size the people who have the pickup problem, not only the market.

CASE STUDY · STEP 3

Research goal, method and questions

Goal: understand where, why and for whom the pickup breaks down, and how riders cope today, before designing any fix.

Method	Size	Purpose
Anonymous survey, shared through community groups	25 responses	Find how common the problem is
One-to-one interviews	10 riders	Learn the reasons and the workarounds
Follow-up interviews after a prototype	5 of the 10 riders	Test whether the fix helps

Key questions used:

1. When did you last book a ride, and where?
2. Where do you usually get picked up, and how do you identify the driver?
3. After booking, how often are you unsure where to wait?
4. What is the most frustrating part of the pickup?
5. When a driver cannot find you, what do you do?
6. Have you ever cancelled, or wanted to, because of the pickup? What caused it?
7. Would an app-suggested, easy-to-find spot help?

LESSON

Ask about the last real event, not about what people would like in the future. Note that a survey of 25 people shows a pattern worth testing, not a measured rate.

CASE STUDY · STEP 4

Competitor pickup landscape

For each competitor, ask: what did they ship, what changed for the user, and what gap remains? The source compares several ride-hailing products. The pattern matters more than the names:

Pattern in the market	What it fixes	What it leaves open
Designated pickup zones at airports	Crowd hunting becomes a matched queue	Everyday pickups outside designated zones
Curated pickup points and hotspots	Phone calls become one agreed point	The same gap outside hotspots
Wrong-pin alerts	Reacts after the wrong pin is set	No guidance layer before the mistake
Venue photos and walking guides	Calls become a photo guide	Not yet a spatial route
Landmark-based pins	Raw GPS becomes a landmark	Needs a good landmark list for each place

The gap for this case: a spatial guidance layer that works at everyday places such as malls, tech parks and streets, not only at designated zones.

CASE STUDY · STEP 5

Root cause: find the layer under the symptoms

Symptoms are things you see: multiple entrances, crowds, safety worries, driver idle time. The root cause is the layer the team can change. The case names two:

- **Positioning:** can the app describe a point the rider can find?
- **Coordination:** can rider and driver meet without a phone call?

Multi-entrance buildings and crowds are environmental constraints. They shape the problem, but the team cannot remove them. Solve the layer that the app controls.

FIVE WHYS PRACTICE

Ask why three times: why do riders call? Why is the pin in the wrong place? Why does the app not show a usable point? Write where the chain reaches a cause the team can change.

CASE STUDY · STEP 6

Three opportunities, with evidence and risk

Opportunity	User problem	Evidence (from the survey and interviews)	Expected benefit	Key risk or dependency
1. Smart pickup spot (safe zones and a 3D map)	Wrong spot: positioning	Most riders want a suggested spot; repeated complaints about several exits	Fewer first calls; more first-attempt pickups	Needs venue mapping with partners such as tech parks, malls and airports: real operational effort
2. Compass and proximity guidance	Driver cannot converge on the rider	Nearly every rider calls the driver when the driver cannot find them	Hands-free guidance in the last 100 metres	Needs reliable live direction data; weaker in dense high-rise areas
3. Verified vehicle ID (photo, plate and a light signal)	Doubt about the right car	Riders report uncertainty about the vehicle	Safer and quicker identification	Needs driver adoption and privacy checks

Rank the three by evidence strength, expected benefit and risk. The source puts the first opportunity at the top because it addresses the root layer directly.

CASE STUDY · STEP 7

Metrics to judge the fix

Metric	Type	Why it matters
First-attempt pickup success	Primary	Shows the spot and guidance work the first time
Calls between rider and driver during pickup	Leading	Falls early if coordination improves
Cancellations after driver assignment	Lagging, guardrail	Must not rise because of the change
Driver waiting time	Guardrail	Must not rise because riders are harder to find

Each opportunity needs a test before a full build. A Wizard-of-Oz test (a manual version behind the screen) can check whether riders use the suggested spot before any mapping is built.

Quiz with answers

1. Name the four segments in the case.
   Answer: tech-park commuters, mall visitors, airport travellers and first-time riders.
2. What is the difference between a symptom and a root cause?
   Answer: a symptom is what you see; a root cause is the layer the team can change.
3. Why ask about the last real event?
   Answer: people describe real events more accurately than future wishes.
4. What is a Wizard-of-Oz test?
   Answer: a manual version of a feature, behind the screen, to test demand before building it.
5. Which metric is a guardrail in this case?
   Answer: cancellations after assignment, or driver waiting time.

MODULE 3 · FINAL

Completion checklist

Completion checklist

Done	Item
☐	Read the coverage map and marked the new steps
☐	Wrote four segments with pain and need for one product
☐	Listed the key questions for a short interview
☐	Built a competitor table with the gap left open
☐	Named the root layer and two symptoms
☐	Answered the quiz without notes

MODULE 3 · COMPLETE CLASS NOTES

Everything else from the class slides

Every point from the class slides that is not already explained earlier in this PDF, grouped by slide. Points already covered are not repeated.

Class · slide 1 Week-3

- Week-3 Problem Discovery, Market and User Research

Class · slide 5 Session Guidelines

- Be honest in questions and feedback.
- Feedback is anonymous and the aggregate data helps both you and me become better.
- If they look like a blocker, I'll pick it up.
- Else, we'll discuss it in the end.
- Don't worry if you don't understand a term, I will post the slides.
- Focus on the message.

Class · slide 7 Part 1:

- Understanding the Key Components of Market Research
- Validating Ideas Using Market Data and Insights
- Applying Frameworks Like TAM-SAM-SOM, Porter's Five Forces, and Customer Discovery
- Evaluating Competitive Landscapes with Confidence

Class · slide 8 How many of you have built features that

- How many of you have built features that didn't get used? "value is in what gets used, not what gets built" - Kris Gale.

Class · slide 9 Problem Discovery

- Problem Discovery What is Problem Discovery?
- You're not creating problems.
- Why It's Called "Discovery"

Class · slide 10 Problem discovery - Why it matters ??

- Reason Why it matters 🎯 Ensures you solve the right problem Reduces wasted effort 💸 Prevents product failures Aligns with real user need 🧠 Builds user empathy Makes PMs better decision-makers 🧭 Fuels innovation Opens up non-obvious solutions 📊 Helps with prioritization Clear inputs for roadmap decisions

Class · slide 11

From Discovering Problems → Understanding the Market

- From Discovering Problems → Understanding the Market You've uncovered what frustrates users.
- You've listened to their pain, observed their behavior, and collected insights.
- But here's the next critical step: Are these problems worth solving - at scale?

Class · slide 14

What is Market Research ?

- Market Research = Understanding the Opportunity Around the Problem Market research helps you assess whether a problem is worth solving at scale.
- It gives a strategic view of the space you're operating in:
- Demand: What is desire of the product or service?
- Market Size: How big is the opportunity, size of the market?
- Industry Trends: What are Industry trends are shaping the space?
- How many are willing to avail/buy this?
- Economic Trends: Customer buying capacity?
- Market Saturation: Are there underserved users?
- Opportunity for new entrant?
- Pricing: Who else is solving this?
- What price are customer paying for the alternative?
- Location: High demand geography?

Class · slide 15

Case Study :- Zomato

- Case Study :- Zomato https://drive.google.com/file/d/1MRKgwQQ9t5WvZgOcWgkJqLz6NKeDje0R/view?usp=sharing

Class · slide 16

Primary Research

- Primary Research First-hand insights directly from your users.
- What it is: You collect new data yourself - directly from market.
- Test early product concepts Examples: 🗣️ 1:1 user interviews 📝 Surveys with open-ended questions 👀 Usability tests on prototypes 📓 Diary studies or field observations

Class · slide 17

Secondary Research

- Secondary Research Leverage existing data to understand the market landscape.
- What it is: You analyze information that already exists - collected by someone else.
- Understand market size Examples: 📊 Industry reports (McKinsey, Statista) 📚 Research papers 🌐 Reddit, Quora, Product Hunt threads 📱 App Store reviews

Class · slide 18

Pro Tip: Combine Both for Better Insight

- Pro Tip: Combine Both for Better Insight Eg: Building a new Fintech app for college students Primary: Interview 10 students about money habits Secondary: Research RBI trends on digital payments in Gen Z Real impact comes when you combine direct user signals with market-level intelligence.

Class · slide 19

Market Sizing

- Market Sizing Estimating the potential of a market using TAM - SAM - SOM framework: Terms Stands for Description TAM Total Addressable Market Total demand for the product if everyone used it SAM Serviceable Available Market Portion of TAM you can serve SOM Serviceable Obtainable Market Realistically achievable market share

Class · slide 20

Market Sizing

- Market Sizing Imagine you are opening a pizza restaurant in Bengaluru - HSR.
- TAM - The Entire Market All possible customers who could buy pizza In India - The pizza market is worth $1 billion annually.
- SAM- Your Reachable Market Portion of TAM that you can realistically serve based on geography and business model Your restaurant is in Bengaluru-HSR, so your market is $10 million.
- SOM - Your Target Customer Realistic market share you can capture based on competition, pricing, and capacity 10% of HSR's pizza market - $1 million a year.

Class · slide 21

Porter's

- Porter's Five Forces Five Forces Model Threat of New Entrants Threat of Substitutes Bargaining Power of Buyers Bargaining Power of Suppliers Rivalry Among Existing Competitors

Class · slide 24

Competitive Analysis

- Competitive Analysis What Identifying, evaluating, and benchmarking competitors to understand their strengths, weaknesses, market positioning, and potential threats.
- Why - Identify Market Gap - Prepare for competitive threats - Build Solid GTM Strategy How - Identify Direct/Indirect and Substitute Competitors - Gather Data for from demos/ press release / Financial report / Customer feedback / word of mouth / Analyst reports - Gartner - Benchmark performance, swot, key features, pricing

Class · slide 25

Competitive Analysis- Case Study

- Competitive Analysis- Case Study Trans.io is an AI startup that provides both real-time and batch transcription services, enabling businesses to convert audio and video content into text with high accuracy and low latency.
- As a Product Manager for Trans.io perform competitive analysis to build the product strategy and roadmap.

Class · slide 26

Competitive

- Competitive Landscape Features & Capabilities (Winner- Speed, Price, Error) Deepgram 1,1,4 Speechmatics 4,3,2 Google 3,2,3 Amazon Transcribe 2,4,1 Infracture & Language support Performance Features Pricing Customer Reviews/ Downtime AWS Support 30+ AWS Support 50 Google Only 125 Native Aws solutions 100 WER (Word Error Rate) - 18.4 Batch File size - unlimited # transcription session @ once → 10 Diarization - Up to 10 WER (Word Error Rate) - 11.3 Batch File size - 2 hours # transcription session @ once = 100 sessions Diarization - Up to 10 WER (Word Error Rate) - 17.7 Batch File size - async 6 hours Diarization - Up to 6 WER (Word Error Rate) - 10.9 Batch File size - 4 hours # transcription session @ once = 100 sessions Diarization - Up to 10 Noise Reduction Deep Search (Audio) Redaction Punctuation Profanity Filter Numeral Formatting Custom Vocabulary
- $0.25/hr $1.3/hr $0.96/hr $1.44/hr

Class · slide 27

Live Class Activity

- Live Class Activity Should Uber enter the 2-wheeler EV ride-hailing segment in India?
- If no, why not?
- Support your decision with data and build Market Analysis & Competition Landscape

Class · slide 30

Part 2:

- Part 2: User Research..
- Why it is needed ?
- User research approaches 🤨
- Define Customer Segments & Personas
- Turn user research into strategy Pitch ☀
- Breakout room activity 😍

Class · slide 31

Learning

- Learning Outcome Learn what, why and how of user research Live Group Activity A group activity to turn user research into strategy Pitch

Class · slide 33

What is User Research?

- Set of approaches to deeply understand your product users from their own perspective (and not via data points or assumed "personas")
- What do people really need wrt your problem space and in what priority order
- If you aren't a direct user, help you put yourself in their shoes - literally
- Approaches change based on which stage the product is at :
- Build a new product from scratch
- Figure what to solve in current product
- Figure how to solve a particular problem in an existing product
- Get confidence on a proposed solution hypothesis
- Or just to figure why are your metrics going haywire... more.

Class · slide 34

Why is it needed?

- Why is it needed?
- Product metrics only answer the "what" - not the "why" or "why not"
- Product strategy is driven the leadership's "personal" assumptions based on what they've seen or heard - not what's the true problem statement.
- By leveraging user research, you get...
- "True confidence" in what you're building before you build it
- OR "True reasons" for why people are doing what they're doing - expected or not
- Remember : Everyone carries a "bias to build" - how well you control & route will single-handedly decide how great of a product professional you will be.

Class · slide 41

Surveys 1/5

- Used to get a "general pulse" from the user's end
- Quickly help decide which direction to dive more into or ignore
- Need enough responses (by volume) to find reliable patterns
- Doesn't have to be only close-ended questions - people happily respond to open-ended queries ("What did you like the most?" // "Any other comments?")
- These responses especially help in getting unexpected, deep insights

Class · slide 42

Surveys 1/5

- Surveys 1/5 Advanced insights
- Fill rate starts to go down drastically after 5 questions.
- Don't use results from surveys as-is to make strategic calls - always augment with a deeper research method.
- For more contextual, reliable & higher response rate try to target the user when they're actually on your product (instead of sending the link to their email or SMS inbox)
- Blitzlamma is one such modern tools that allows this.

Class · slide 43

Passive user observation 2/5

- Passive user observation 2/5
- Observing how people actually use a product in their natural setting - your product or a competing/lateral product
- Understand users in an unbiased fashion
- Helps generate deeper questions to ask
- New insights to leverage for product design
- Figure which product flows can be killed or trimmed

Class · slide 44

Passive user observation 2/5

- Step 1 : Look at "user flow chart" to identify interesting parts of product to observe :
- Is there a particular flow that 90% users keep using frequently?
- Is there a step where users are spending too much time and/or are dropping off?
- Where do users head to, right after launching the product?
- This is a standard visualisation in product analytics tools like Mixpanel & Amplitude.

Class · slide 45

Passive user observation 2/5

- Step 2 : Use screen recording/analytics to "see" what people are actually doing across these flows
- Screen recording tools like (free) Clarity from microsoft, (paid) UXcam for mobile apps, (paid) Smartlook for web products

Class · slide 46

Active user observation 3/5

- Active user observation 3/5
- Live, guided version of product usage observation
- Get people to use a product - your product or competitor or a design prototype - while both of you're able to talk to each other.
- You can "listen" to what's going in their mind
- You can ask clarifying questions
- You can nudge them in the right direction (based on your goal)

Class · slide 47

➔Using design prototype (most popular!)

- Using design prototype (most popular!) Very useful to test understandability (are people able to figure what this is? are they excited to use it?) and usability (are people able to use it on their own? are they delighted while using it?)

Class · slide 48

Tips :

- Be ready with 2-3 tasks that you want them to complete - don't define steps, define goals (how would you book a view using this?)
- People won't be able to understand that it's a prototype (and not a real product) so make the information & interactions on the screens is as realistic as possible.

Class · slide 49

1:n conversation 4/5

- Moderated research where questions are asked about user's perceptions, beliefs, opinion or ideas - across user segments.
- Free flow discussion (Participants are encouraged to talk openly) - Focus group discussion.
- Optimum group size : 8 to 12 users
- Users need to be recruited and pre-screened

Class · slide 51

In depth interviews (IDP) 5/5

- In depth interviews (IDP) 5/5
- One-on-one interview with the participant.
- Guiding Research Questionnaire is used, but flexible to ask follow up questions based on participant's answers.
- Start with general questions and then move to more specific ones.
- Ask ice-breaker questions to make the participant feel comfortable.

Class · slide 63

Source: Warwick Allchorn (Linkedin)

- Source: Warwick Allchorn (Linkedin) What is not User Persona?
- Raised in the UK
- Lives in a castle
- Wealthy & famous PRINCE CHARLES
- Raised in the UK
- Lives in a castle
- Wealthy & famous OZZY OSBOURNE

Class · slide 65

Example User Persona

- Example User Persona User Persona for Pay via UPI at Fuel Stations Product

Class · slide 66

Take-home Assignment

- Take-home Assignment Uber is one of the most widely used mobility platforms, helping millions of users get from point A to point B quickly and reliably.
- However, for many users-especially in dense urban areas-the experience after booking a ride can still feel uncertain and stressful.
- Once a ride is confirmed, users often struggle with questions like: Where exactly should I stand?
- Will the driver find me easily?
- Should I move to a better pickup point?
- In crowded locations such as malls, office complexes, airports, or busy streets, drivers may find it difficult to reach the exact pinned location.
- This often leads to multiple calls, cancellations, or delays.
- While Uber shows a pickup point and ETA, it does not always proactively guide users toward the most optimal or realistic pickup experience in complex environments.
- Uber is exploring whether it can play a more active role in helping users coordinate pickups more effectively, reduce confusion, and improve overall reliability of the pickup experience.
- As a Product Manager, your task is to evaluate this opportunity and outline how you would approach understanding the problem before proposing solutions.

Class · slide 67

Take-home Assignment

- Take-home Assignment Your Task: Step 1: Conduct Market Research and Comp Analysis around this proposition
- Analyze demand across user segments
- Identify and size the target market
- Study existing alternatives users rely on today
- Assess restrictions, rules and other laws
- Assess market trends Step 2: Conduct In-Depth User Interviews (use Surveymonkey, Lovable)
- Talk to at least 10 person
- Capture qualitative insights-ask open-ended questions to understand user behavior, preferences, and frustrations.
- Record proof of interviews:
- Videos or pictures of interviewees (with their consent).
- Screenshots of messages if interviews are conducted online.
- Step 3: Summarise your insights & Define Segment, Target and Persona for the selected segment.
- Week 3 : Session 2 (take home assignment) Template

Class · slide 69

User profiles:

- User profiles: Fintech - Budgeting App "I've tried using budgeting apps before, but they feel like a chore.
- I just want something that works quietly in the background and nudges me when I'm overspending." - 32 y/o marketing professional, lives in a metro city "I check my bank app almost every day, but I still don't really know where my money goes each month." - 28 y/o software engineer, single, lives in a tier-1 city "I know I should save more, but life's unpredictable.
- Sometimes I just need flexibility without guilt." - 35 y/o freelance graphic designer, parent of one, lives in a suburban area "I want to feel in control of my money without spending hours each week analyzing charts." - 25 y/o content creator, lives in a shared flat, spends irregularly "I share finances with my partner, and we always struggle with transparency and splitting shared expenses." - 34 y/o project manager, cohabiting, lives in an urban area

Class · slide 70

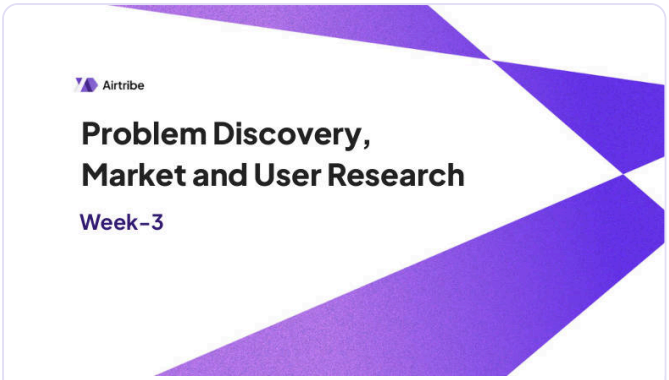
Fintech - Budgeting App

- Fintech - Budgeting App "I don't earn a lot, so every rupee matters.
- I just want a simple way to avoid end-of-month surprises.” - 29 y/o call center executive, rents a small apartment, lives in a tier-2 city "I've got multiple credit cards and EMIs, and sometimes I forget what's due when.
- I need something that helps me stay ahead without stressing me out.” - 38 y/o sales professional, married with two kids, lives in a metro city "I'm trying to build wealth, but most financial tools feel made for people who already have money.” - 27 y/o early-stage startup employee, investing beginner, lives in a co-living space "My parents depend on me financially.
- I need to manage not just my money, but theirs too.” - 31 y/o government employee, single, primary breadwinner, lives in a joint family in a small town "I love tracking every transaction-it gives me peace of mind.
- But I wish I didn't have to switch between five different apps to do it.” - 30 y/o chartered accountant, meticulous planner, lives in a metro city "I travel a lot for work, so my spending patterns are erratic.
- I need something smart enough to adapt to that.” - 33 y/o management consultant, frequent traveler, lives in serviced apartment

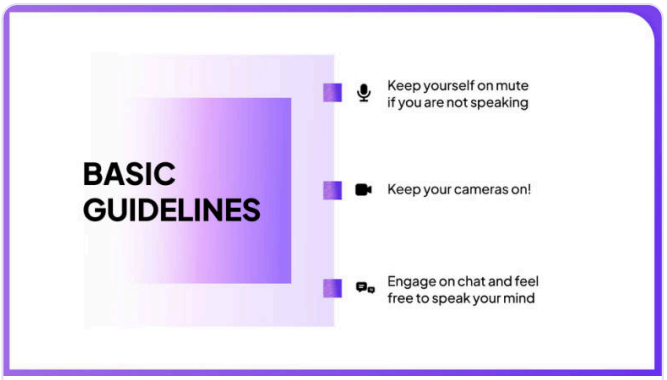
MODULE 3 · SLIDE VISUALS

Visual slides from the class

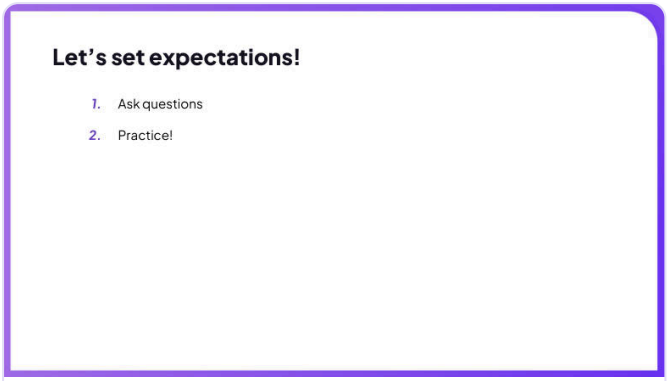
These slides are mostly pictures and diagrams, so they are shown as images. Read them with the notes above.



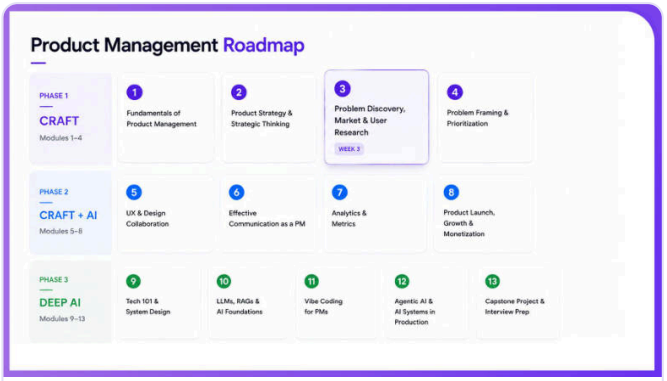
Slide 1



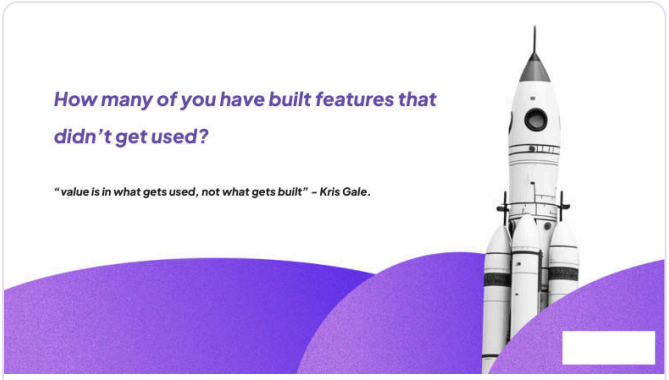
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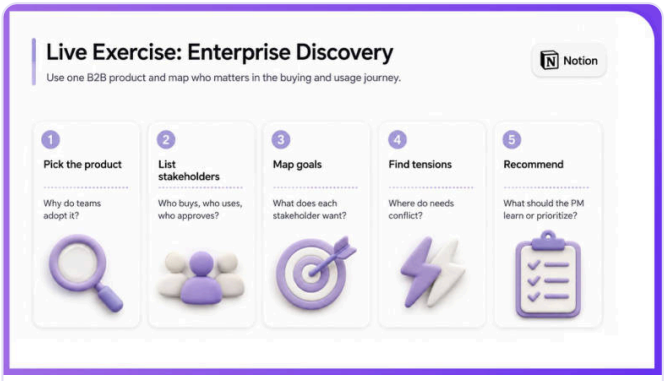
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Slide 6



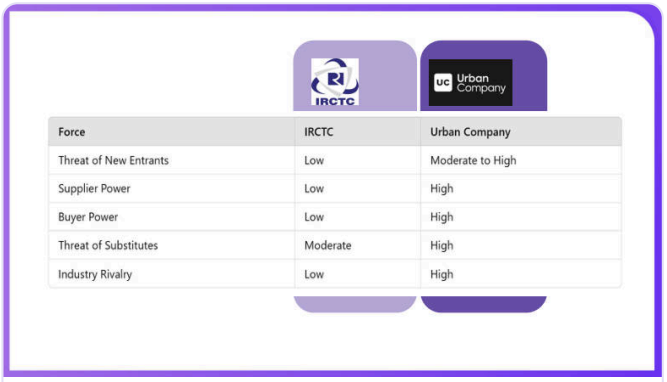
Slide 8



Slide 12

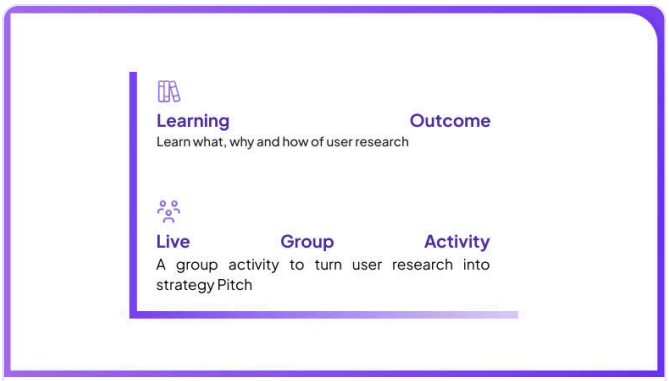


Slide 15



Force	IRCTC	Urban Company
Threat of New Entrants	Low	Moderate to High
Supplier Power	Low	High
Buyer Power	Low	High
Threat of Substitutes	Moderate	High
Industry Rivalry	Low	High

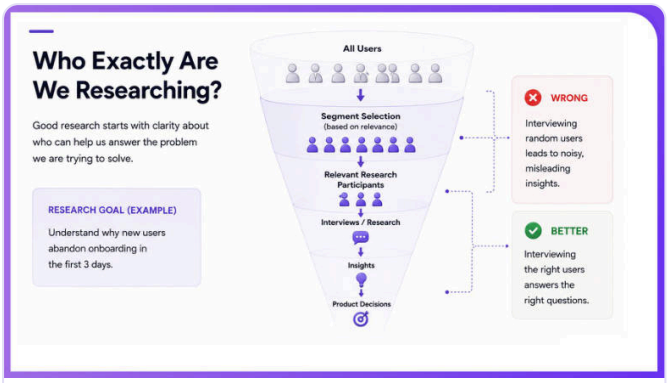
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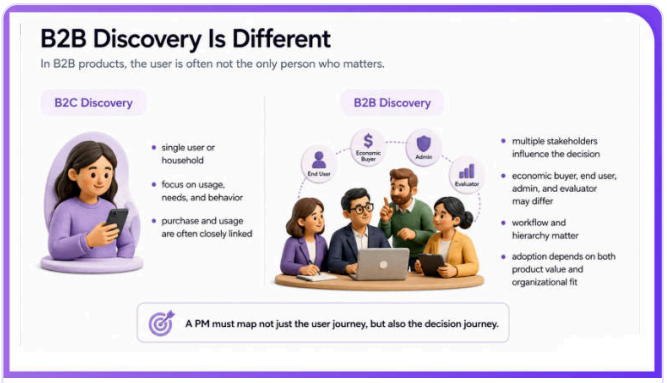
Slide 31



Slide 32



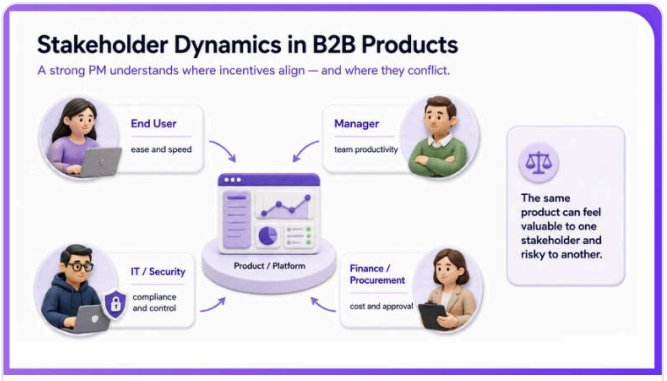
Slide 35



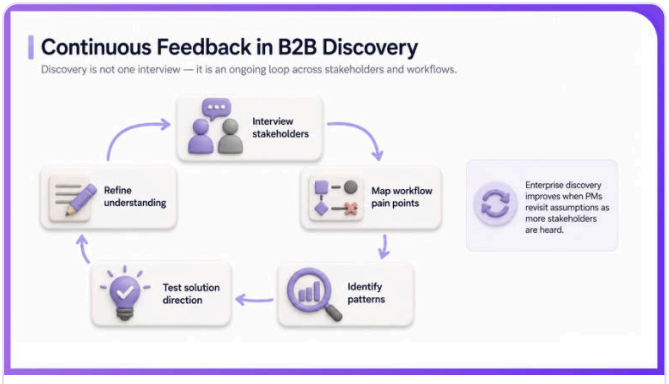
Slide 36



Slide 37



Slide 38



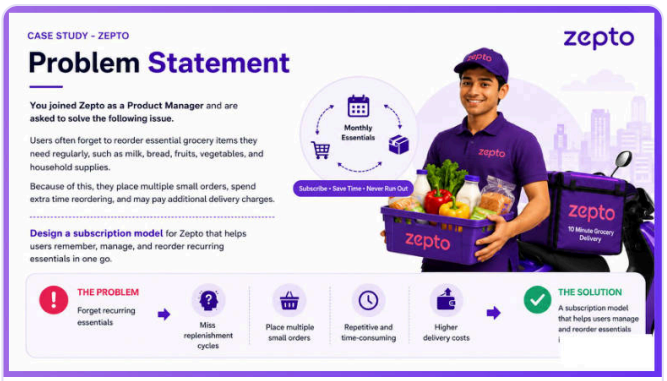
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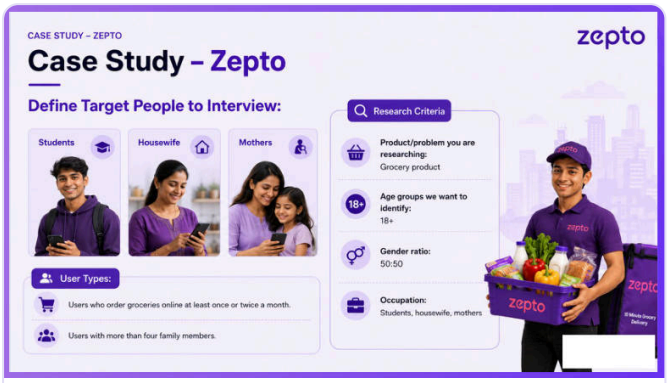
Slide 40



Slide 50



Slide 52



Slide 53



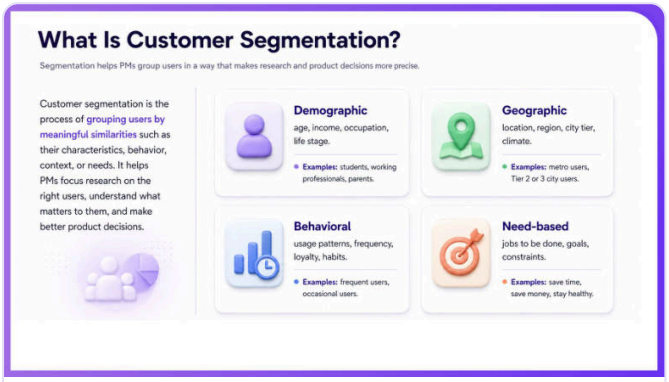
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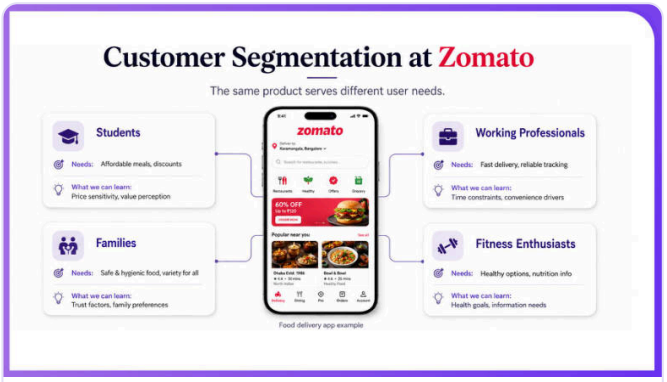
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Slide 56



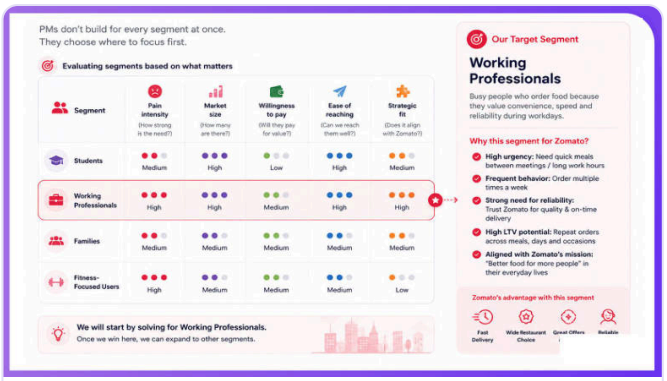
Slide 57



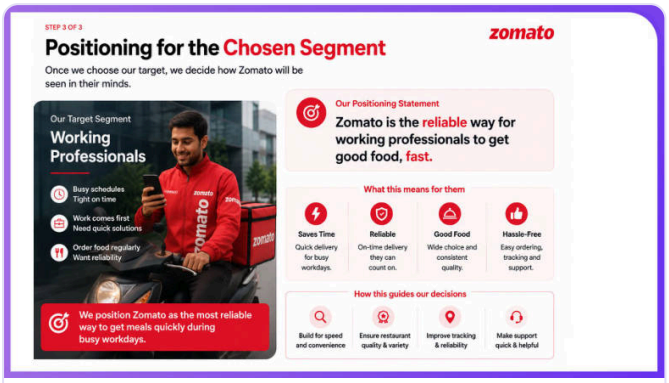
Slide 58



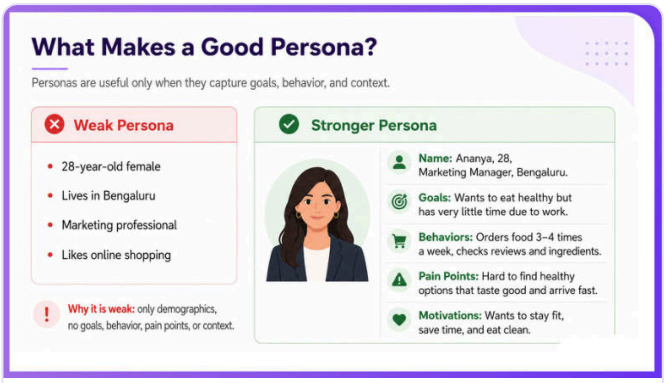
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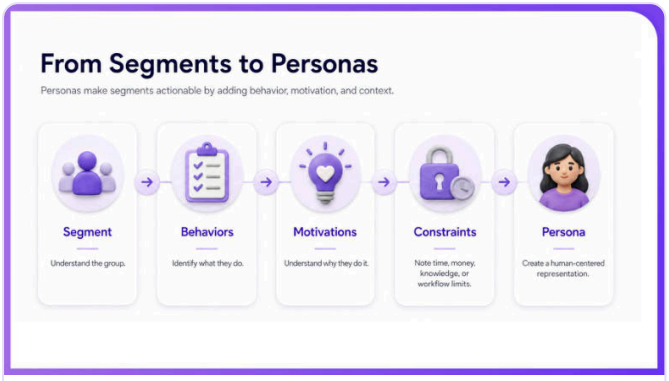
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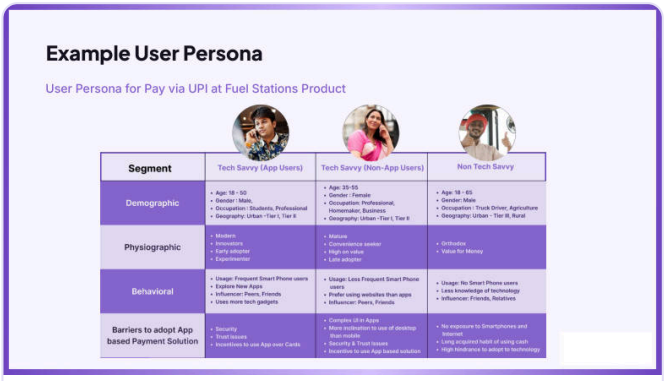
Slide 61



Slide 62



Slide 64



Slide 65